itself, it cannot check its own validity, which stands in need of confirmation by another cognition.

The ***Purva Mimamsaka*** ritual tradition ritual insists that the *Vedic* scriptures are the only means of knowledge about social and religious duty (***dharma***). They hold that the authority of the *Vedas* is self-validating (*svatah pramanya*). The truth of the *Vedas* does not need confirmation or proof. ***Purva Mimamsakas***, ***Samkhyas*** and ***Vedantins*** hold that cognitions are intrinsically valid in the sense that the very same conditions that generated the cognition also make it true. If cognitions are true intrinsically they do not need to be confirmed by successful activity (which would require another cognition, leading to an infinite regress). But, more strongly, the theory of intrinsic validity means that one can know something without knowing that one knows. Knowledge, having a true belief, does not require subjective certainty. A cognitive state with a reliable causal history (one generated by a means of knowledge – ***pramana***) is knowledge immediately upon its occurrence and does not need the subject to check and justify it. A belief is automatically justified if there is an appropriate causal connection between its content and what it is about.

See ***paratah pramanya***

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; K. Bhattacharya 1998; Burton 1999

Svatah siddha (self-evident proof): the view that the conscious self proves its own existence. It does not need to be established by anything other than itself. Knowledge of one's own consciousness is not mediated by an appropriate causal chain or by a reliable mechanism in the way in which our beliefs about external objects are. We have direct access to consciousness. There is something unique about our knowledge of our own experience.